

Planned Chapters of the Social Platform Investment Paper

01 The Thesis

Social platforms as strategic infrastructure

Social platforms should be understood not just as consumer apps, but as strategic infrastructure. They shape how people form identity, consume information, build trust, and organise communities. If digital sovereignty and societal resilience matter, then the platforms that mediate public attention and social behaviour matter too. Europe already has the talent, ambition, and cultural depth to build important social platforms; the core investment thesis is that these platforms are increasingly a form of defence tech.

02 Why Now? The Structural Shift

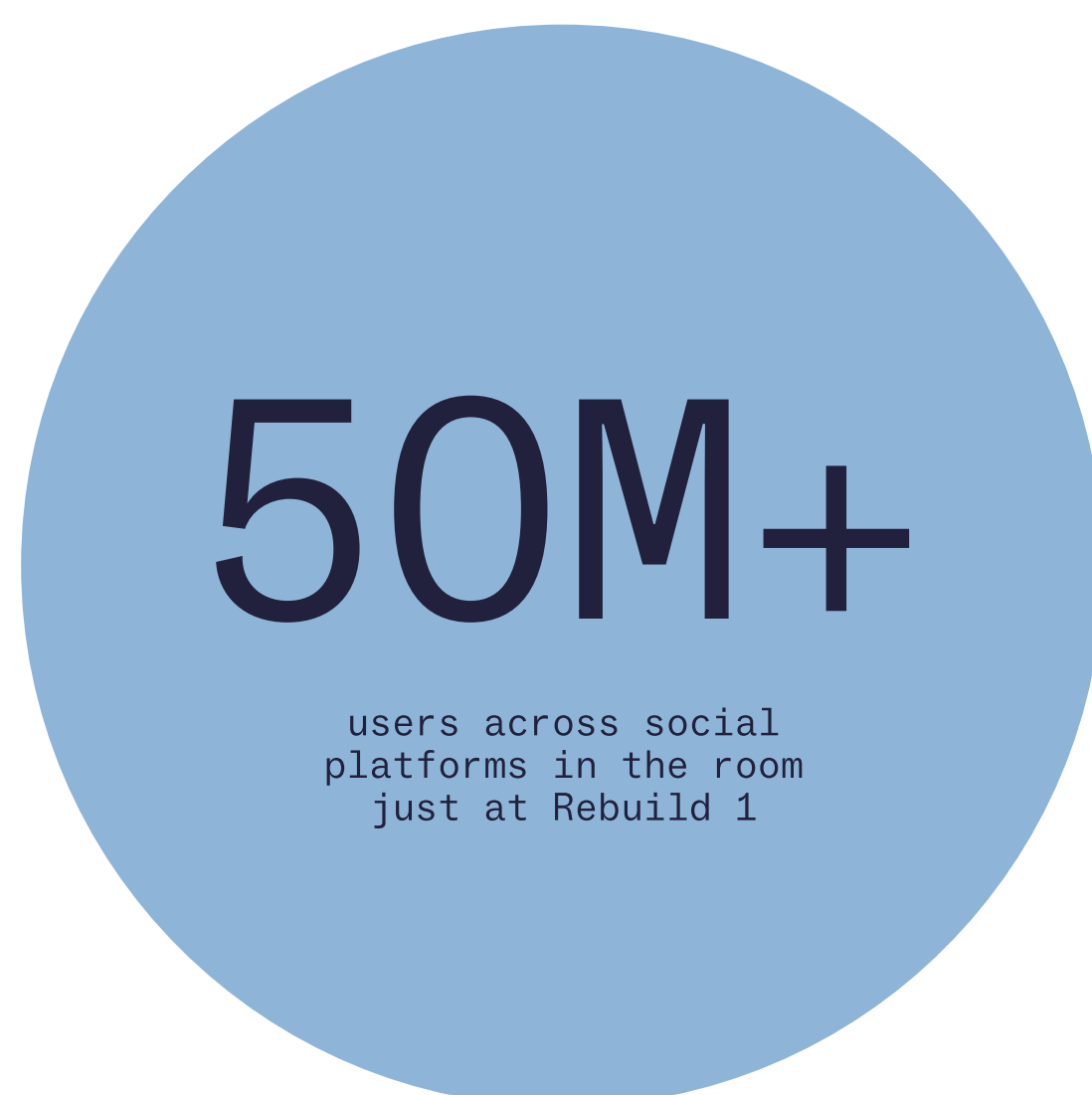
The changing context of creation

The reason to invest now is that the structural context around social platforms has changed. The next generation will be built in a different environment: lower costs of creation, new AI-enabled product possibilities, more fragmented user demand, and rising concern around trust and safety. Users are looking beyond one-size-fits-all global feeds toward smaller, more intentional, more trusted environments. This is less a repeat of old consumer social and more the emergence of a new class of social infrastructure.

03 The Opportunity: Size & Shape

Broader than "social media"

The opportunity is broader than traditional "social media" and should be framed as social infrastructure. The category includes trusted communities, identity-rich networks, information platforms, local coordination systems, safer youth products, creator ecosystems, and democracy-tech tools. The unifying feature is not format but ownership of a valuable social layer. Framing the category too narrowly makes investors underestimate both the market size and the strategic significance of what is being built.



04 European Success Cases

Leading instead of following

Europe has too often followed proven social models instead of leading new ones. When investors wait for a social behaviour to be fully legible, they usually arrive too late, leading to backing local copies rather than funding original products. If Europe wants meaningful outcomes in this space, it has to fund insight before consensus, and it has to back founders creating new social formats. The real opportunity is to champion what is already working while removing the blockers that prevent scale.

05 Capital Gaps & Friction

The capital paradox

Europe has underbuilt in social not because the opportunity was weak, but because the capital model was. The category has historically looked messy to venture: nonlinear growth, uncertain monetisation, and heavy behavioural risk. The historical blocker has been exit-driven capital trying to fund businesses that require patience. Social platforms often compound through trust, habit, and community behaviour rather than through immediate revenue efficiency, creating a mismatch with investors looking for fast proof points.

06 Investment Models

New architectures for new platforms

The business models for the next generation of social platforms will be more varied than the last. The next wave can monetise through subscriptions, transactions, premium tooling, identity layers, community SaaS, or micropayments. Consequently, some of the best social platforms will require new ownership and financing models. Stewardship models, public-private partnerships, blended capital, or mission-protective governance structures may produce better outcomes, better matching financing to the nature of the asset being built.

07 The Investor Call to Action

Financing platforms like they matter

The investor call to action is to treat social platforms as serious, strategic, and worth backing with conviction. This means moving beyond the old instinct that social is soft or unserious, and recognising that trust, safety, culture, and information integrity are core product primitives. It means backing patient founders earlier and widening the range of acceptable business models. Europe can build globally important social platforms if it starts financing them like they matter.